

Worksheet: “What Type of Research Is This?”

For each scenario below, identify:

1. **Purpose** (Exploratory, Descriptive, Explanatory)
2. **Use** (Basic, Applied)
3. **Time Dimension** (Cross-sectional, Longitudinal)
4. **Data Collection** (Quantitative, Qualitative, Mixed Methods)
5. **Explanation/Summary**

Scenario 1:

A team of computer scientists is developing a new algorithm to detect fake news on social media. They first run a small pilot study with 50 users to understand how people interact with suspicious posts.

- **Purpose:**
- **Use:**
- **Time:**
- **Data Collection:**
- **Explanation/Summary**

Scenario 2:

A university conducts an annual survey of all graduating students to collect data on their job placements, salaries, and further education plans. This year, 5,000 students responded.

- **Purpose:**
- **Use:**
- **Time:**
- **Data Collection:**
- **Explanation/Summary**

Scenario 3:

A researcher is studying the long-term effects of remote work on software developers' productivity and well-being. She interviews the same 30 developers every 6 months over 3 years.

- **Purpose:**
- **Use:**
- **Time:**
- **Data Collection:**
- **Explanation/Summary**

Scenario 4:

A cybersecurity firm wants to understand why certain organizations fall victim to phishing attacks more often than others. They analyze past attack data and conduct in-depth interviews with IT staff from affected companies.

- **Purpose:**
- **Use:**
- **Time:**
- **Data Collection:**
- **Explanation/Summary**

Scenario 5:

A computer science department conducts a one-time online poll asking students about their preferred programming languages for a new introductory course.

- **Purpose:**
- **Use:**
- **Time:**
- **Data Collection:**
- **Explanation/Summary**